

Shoulds Worksheet

Part One: You Are Here

1. What reaction or feeling has let you know that you are not in peace?
2. What feelings are you experiencing? *(Circle all the words below that describe your feelings and make a note of any others not listed here. You might also notice where in your body you feel these emotions)*

Discouraged	Anxious	Fatigued	Resistant	Strained
Disappointed	Tense	Indignant	Irritable/angry	Remorseful
Disgusted	Self-loathing	Self-punishing	Fearful/phobic	Confused
Failure/defeated	Disloyal	Guilty	Double-minded	Obsessive
Not good enough	Restless	Scrambling	Embarrassed	Hate
Bored	Reckless	Paralyzed	Destructive	Stagnant
Obstructed	Missing out	Manipulated	Coerced/compelled	Shut down
Vindictive	Sad	Used/abused	Craving	Shame
Inauthentic	Trapped	Secretive	Deprived	Aggressive

Are you experiencing a physical reaction (e.g., trembling, bingeing, insomnia, faint, loss of appetite, twitches, digestive distress, headaches, unsafe driving or choices, awkwardness, heart issues)?

3. When did you start feeling this way? Can you identify an event that triggered the feelings?
4. How are you compelled or tempted to regain your comfort or a feeling of doing the “right” thing?

Part Two: Looking Deeply

1. What did you do that was “wrong”? Or, what should you have done better?
2. Finish the statements:

I should always _____.

I should never _____.

Possible shoulds: *live up to my or another’s standard; endure everything and everyone; understand everything and everyone; like everything and everyone; be productive; love my family; be completely honest; get my way; be detached; predict the future; forget the past; read minds; be successful; sacrifice myself; assert myself; feel hurt or betrayed; be out of control; feel unloved; command devotion; feel happy; win; lose; look good; make a mistake; get involved; take a risk; be a victim; express my preferences.* See page 65 in *Neurosis and Human Growth* (1991) for other examples.

3. Complete this statement: I would be perfect if only _____
_____.
4. What limitation(s) are you experiencing?

Part 3: Recovery

1. Recall the Two Paths Flow Chart. What judgment did you make about your performance? BAD/GOOD
2. If you cannot perform perfectly, what do you fear? Have you lost an aspect of imagined glory?
3. Without judgment simply list the sequence of events in the situation. Take the Believe It Path.
4. Are you willing to let go of judging yourself, even though you may not be free of the fear? YES/NO

If you are not ready to let go of the should, you might try prayer. Confess to God your illusions about what it is to be perfect and godlike. Admit that you have judged yourself for not being perfect. Acknowledge the arrogance and unkindness of imposing on yourself something that you have found impossible. Would you impose the same standard on someone else? Do you? You might now try a Body Talk Tap. Tap the crown of your head with your palm, then tap over your heart.

5. Rejoice in the truth of your discoveries about yourself, others, and the Creation. What have you learned?
6. Are you now ready to take action? Do you agree with this prayer?

Father and Creator, I used this event to misorient and took the Judgment Path. I blamed myself for not living up to my imagined abilities. I refused to take the Believe It Path and did not want to rejoice in the truth that this situation revealed about me. I felt the "fear of death" and tried to save my life. I now choose to reorient to the glory that You created for me as Your creature. I will give up adhering to this self-imposed standard of _____. I submit to the training that You have presented to me. Thank You for making me aware of my need for gradual development and for leading me to another opportunity to heal and grow into my potential.

Take a deep breath

7. Integrate what you have learned. You might, for example, use a tap, UFO Hold, TAT, Healing Color, or a meditation. If you choose the tap, you might use a clearing statement like this: My problem is that I judged this event as good/evil, and when I think of that, I feel _____
8. Report to the group and celebrate your effort.